The word cloud in figure 5.30 is fundamentally the same, but instead of using color and rotation for aesthetics, we used them to encode information in the dataset. You can read about more controls over the format of your word cloud, including selecting fonts and padding, in the layout's documentation at https://www.jasondavies.com/wordcloud/about/.

Layouts like the word cloud aren't suitable for as wide a variety of data as some other layouts, but because they're so easy to deploy and customize, you can combine them with other charts to represent the multiple facets of your data. You'll see this kind of synchronized chart in chapter 9.

5.7 Summary

In this chapter, we took an in-depth look at D3 layout structure and experimented with several datasets. In doing so, you learned how to use layouts not just to draw one particular chart, but also variations on that chart. You also experimented with interactivity and animation.

In particular, we covered

- Layout structure and functions common to D3 core layouts
- Arc and diagonal generators for drawing arcs and connecting links
- How to make pie charts and donut charts using the pie layout
- Using tweens to better animate the graphical transition for arc segments (pie pieces)
- How to create circle-packing diagrams and format them effectively using the pack layout
- How to create vertical, horizontal, and radial dendrograms using the tree layout
- How to create stacked area charts, streamgraphs, and stacked bar charts using the stack layout
- How to use noncore D3 layouts to build Sankey diagrams and word clouds

Now that you understand layouts in general, in the next chapter we'll focus on how to represent networks. We'll spend most of our time working with the force-directed layout, which has much in common with general layouts but is distinguished from them because it's designed to be interactive and animated. Because the chapter deals with network data, like the kind you used for the Sankey layout in this chapter, you'll also learn a few tips and tricks for processing and measuring networks.